

The driest place in India is Jaisalmer. It is located in Rajasthan. The state of Rajasthan is also the home to the hottest and driest desert in India, the Thar Desert.

7. Which of the following receives heavy rainfall in the month of October and November?

- (a) Hills of Garo, Khasi and Jaintia
- (b) Coromandel Coasts
- (c) Plateau of Chota Nagpur
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

Most parts of the country receive rainfall from June to September. But some parts like the Coromandel coasts coast gets a large portion of its rain during October and November. Mawsynram in the southern ranges of the Khasi Hills receives the highest average rainfall in the world.

iii. Winter Rainfall

1. Which of the following, the state receives rainfall in winter season—

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) West Bengal
- (d) Odisha

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Ans. (b)

Coastal areas of Tamil Nadu receive winter rainfall due to retreating North-East Monsoon. Additionally, Punjab also receives winter rainfall due to Western Disturbance.

2. The place of origin of Western Disturbances active in North- Western India in winter season is

- (a) Asia Minor
- (b) Western Asia
- (c) Mediterranean coastal area of Western Asia
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Western disturbances are storms that originate in the Caspian or Mediterranean Sea, and bring non-monsoonal rainfall to the North Western India. They are labelled as an extra-tropical storm originating in the Mediterranean, is an area of low pressure that brings sudden showers, snow and fog in North Western India.

Natural Disasters

1. Which of the following coasts of India is most affected by violent tropical cyclones?

- (a) Malabar
- (b) Coromandel
- (c) Konkan
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

Tropical cyclones are violent storms that originate over oceans in tropical areas and move over to the coastal areas bringing about large scale destruction caused by violent winds, very heavy rainfall and storm surges. This is one of the most devastating natural calamities. They are known as Cyclones in the Indian Ocean, Coromandel coasts of India are most affected by violent tropical cyclones.

2. Which of the following statements is true regarding earthquakes?

- (a) P-waves are transverse waves.
- (b) The place on the surface above focus is called epicentre.
- (c) Studying animal behaviour is one of the methods of prediction of earthquakes adopted by local people.
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (d)

The Focus is the place inside Earth's crust where an earthquake originates. The point on the Earth's surface directly above the focus is the epicenter. When energy is released at the focus, seismic waves travel outward from that point in all direction. An earthquake generates both transverse wave(s) and longitudinal (e) sound waves in the earth. There are many methods of prediction of earthquakes but studying animal behaviour is one of the methods of prediction of earthquakes adopted by local people.

3. Match List-I (Natural Hazards) with List-II (Regions) and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Natural Hazards)	List-II (Regions)
A. Floods	1. Himalayan foothill Zone
B. Earthquakes	2. Jharkhand and Northern Odisha